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$$\frac{3}{4}\lambda = L_2 + e \qquad (11.82)$$

In order to avoid end correction, let us take the difference of equation (11.80) and equation (11.79), we get

$$\frac{3}{4}\lambda - \frac{1}{4}\lambda = (L_2 + e) - (L_1 + e)$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{1}{2}\lambda = L_2 - L_1 = \Delta L$$

$$\Rightarrow \lambda = 2\Delta L$$

The speed of the sound in air at room temperature can be computed by using the formula

$$v = f\lambda = 2f\Delta L$$

Further, to compute the end correction, we use equation (11.81) and equation (11.82), we get

$$e = \frac{L_2 - 3L_1}{2}$$

EXAMPLE 11.27

A frequency generator with fixed frequency of 343 Hz is allowed to vibrate above a 1.0 m high tube. A pump is switched on to fill the water slowly in the tube. In order to get resonance, what must be the minimum height of the water?. (speed of sound in air is 343 m s^{-1})

Solution

The wavelength, $\lambda = \frac{c}{f}$

$$\lambda = \frac{343\,ms^{-1}}{343\,Hz} = 1.0 \text{ m}$$

Let the length of the resonant columns be L_1, L_2 and L_3. The first resonance occurs at length L_1

$$L_1 = \frac{\lambda}{4} = \frac{1}{4} = 0.25 \text{ m}$$

The second resonance occurs at length L_2

$$L_2 = \frac{3\lambda}{4} = \frac{3}{4} = 0.75 \text{ m}$$

The third resonance occurs at length

$$L_3 = \frac{5\lambda}{4} = \frac{5}{4} = 1.25 \text{ m}$$

and so on.

Since total length of the tube is 1.0 m the third and other higher resonances do not occur. Therefore, the minimum height of water H_{min} for resonance is,

H_{min} = 1.0 m − 0.75 m = 0.25 m

EXAMPLE 11.28

A student performed an experiment to determine the speed of sound in air using the resonance column method. The length of the air column that resonates in the fundamental mode with a tuning fork is 0.2 m. If the length is varied such that the same tuning fork resonates with the first overtone at 0.7 m. Calculate the end correction.

Solution

End correction

$$e = \frac{L_2 - 3L_1}{2} = \frac{0.7 - 3(0.2)}{2} = 0.05m$$

EXAMPLE 11.29

Consider a tuning fork which is used to produce resonance in an air column. A resonance air column is a glass tube whose length can be adjusted by a variable piston. At room temperature, the two successive resonances observed are at 20 cm and 85 cm of the column length. If the frequency of the length is 256 Hz, compute the velocity of the sound in air at room temperature.